

What this is

A controller that drives the carriage and the cross slide with stepper motors, keeping them in step with the spindle. It does the job of change gears and a lead screw, and adds automatic operations on top: mark the corners of the cut and it will make the passes for you.

Limits	Most jobs need you to mark the corners of the cut first — how far along, and how deep in — with the four limit keys. They are not guard rails: they are the cut.
Passes	A cut taken in stages. You say how many; it divides the depth between them and lifts the tool clear on the way back.
Feed	How far the tool moves per turn of the spindle. On a thread that is the pitch; on a turning cut it sets the finish.
It moves itself	Keep clear, know where the stop key is, and try anything new with the tool well away from the work.

Reading the screen

THRD* off step 1.00
Pitch 1.50mm x2
Z 12.345 X 25.400
3/3 Go Z-5.00mm?

Top	Which job is selected, whether it is running, a small mark for each limit you have set, and how far one tap of a jog key moves.
Second	The feed, and the number of starts if the thread has more than one.
Third	Where the tool is. A slashed X means that figure is a diameter.
Bottom	Everything else — the setup questions, how many passes are done, why something was refused, and whichever readout you have turned on.

The **display** key changes what the bottom line shows when it is otherwise idle: spindle angle, then spindle speed alongside the cutting speed at the tool, then big position digits you can read from a few feet away, then nothing.

Typing numbers into it

Digits fill in from the left, so **4** then **2** is 42. The **backspace key** is the **decimal point**, and it works as a leading point — **.5** is half a millimetre with no need for the zero. **Hold** that key to clear the number and start over; there is no single-digit delete.

Nothing is acted on until you press the key that uses it, and the bottom line shows what your number comes to first — **Use 4.25mm?** — so a misplaced point is something you can see rather than something you find in the work. Where a fraction cannot mean anything, such as a count of passes, the point key beeps instead of typing one.

What you are typing	In what	Looks like	Where it is asked
A distance or a position	millimetres, or inches in inch mode	4 · .5 · 4.25	moves, the four limits, backlash, clearance
A feed	millimetres per turn of the spindle	0.1	gearbox, cross-feed, turning, facing, parting, taper
A thread pitch	millimetres per turn, or threads per inch in tpi mode	1.5 · 11.5	threading, tapered threading
Thread depth	millimetres inwards from the surface — set as the up limit	0.92	threading; twice that in diameter readout
A taper	a ratio, no unit — change in diameter per unit of length	.0625	taper, tapered threading
An angle	degrees	90 · .5	moves and limits on the fourth axis, if fitted
A steady feed	millimetres per second , the spindle out of it	2	steady feed only
A count of something	a whole number — the point key beeps rather than typing	8	passes, spring passes, thread starts, spindle divisions
A surface speed	metres per minute, or feet per minute in inch mode — whole	90	the cutting speed helper, in the settings

The **measure** key swaps the whole machine between millimetres, inches and threads per inch at any time — it changes how figures are shown and typed, never what the machine has stored, so nothing moves and nothing is lost. Set it to match the drawing in front of you.

Taper ratios

What to type when the taper or tapered-thread setup asks for a ratio. It is the change in **diameter** per unit of length — (large – small) ÷ length — so a taper quoted as 1 in 16 is entered as 0.0625.

Taper	Enter	Included	Where
Morse 1	0.0499	2° 51'	tailstock and spindle tooling
Morse 2	0.0500	2° 52'	the commonest on small lathes
Morse 3	0.0502	2° 53'	–
Morse 4	0.0519	2° 59'	–

Taper	Enter	Included	Where
Morse 5	0.0526	3° 1'	–
NPT and BSPT	0.0625	3° 35'	taper pipe threads, 1 in 16
1 in 10	0.1000	5° 43'	–
1 in 20	0.0500	2° 52'	–

Working from an angle instead: ratio = 2 × tan(half the included angle). Cutting a taper on the outside and a matching socket needs the same ratio for both — the mode does not care which way round you are cutting.

Setting up a new machine

Flash the firmware, then choose millimetres or inches with the measure key. The controller has to be told about your lathe before it can be accurate, and it can measure most of that itself. **Hold** the settings key, choose **Calibration**, press play, and work down this list — it begins with the routines that move nothing and ends with the one that deliberately stalls a motor.

#	Routine	Does it move?	What it is for
1	Input tester	nothing moves	Press every key and check it registers. Confirms the panel works before anything is asked to move.
2	Encoder signal	nothing moves	Watches the spindle sensor for electrical interference. Should sit at 100 while the spindle turns.
3	Encoder PPR	you turn the chuck	Turn the spindle a set number of times by hand; it works out how finely the sensor reads.
4	Encoder direction	nothing moves	Turn the spindle forwards. If the number counts down instead of up, this flips it.
5	Z / X direction	the axis moves	Checks each axis travels the way you expect, before anything is measured against it.
6	Z / X screw pitch	the axis moves	Moves a set distance; you measure what it actually moved, and it corrects itself to match.
7	Z / X backlash	the axis moves	Finds the slack in each screw against a dial indicator, so it can be taken up automatically.
8	Z / X travel limit	you jog it	Wind each axis to its ends so the controller knows how far it is allowed to go.
9	Z / X max speed	the axis moves	Speeds up until the motor stalls, then backs off. Leave this one until last.

Then save what you have done — there is no undo. Connect a computer over USB, send a single \$, and it prints every setting as a list of lines you can keep in a text file. Paste them back to restore. The same file can be downloaded from the web page.

Settings that describe your lathe

Hold the settings key to open the menu. Everything here describes the machine itself, and you will mostly set it once. Anything to do with one particular job — how many passes, how much clearance — lives on that job's own page instead, which is a **short** press of the same key.

How things behave		Each axis · Z, X and the fourth	
X readout	Whether the cross slide shows how far it is from centre, or the diameter that gives — twice as much. Lathe work is usually quoted as a diameter.	Invert direction	If the axis travels the wrong way.
Retract distance	How far the tool jumps clear when you press the retract key.	Backlash	The slack in the screw, taken up automatically whenever it reverses.
Manual step time	How long one tap of a jog key takes.	Lead screw pitch	How far the axis moves for one turn of its screw.
Step rest	A pause between stepped moves.	Motor steps/rev	From the motor and its driver settings together.
Spindle divisions	Turns the angle display into an indexer for cutting flats or keyways. 0 is off; 6 gives you a hexagon.	Motor / screw pulley	Tooth counts, if the motor drives through a belt.
Index tolerance	How close to a mark counts as being on it.	Start speed	How gently it sets off before speeding up.
Constant speed	The single switch for the cutting-speed helper below.	Max speed	The fastest it will travel.
Material	What you are cutting. Sets a sensible cutting speed for you.	Acceleration	How briskly it gets up to that speed.
Tool	High speed steel or carbide. Carbide takes roughly three times the speed.	Max travel	How far the axis can physically go, used as a safety net.
Manual speed	Your own figure, used when Material is set to Manual.	Hold when idle	Whether the motor stays locked when stopped. Turn off if it runs hot.
Spindle max rpm	The fastest your lathe runs, so it never suggests more.	Fitted / Rotary	Fourth axis only: whether it exists, and whether it turns or slides.
Spindle sensor		Handwheels	
Encoder PPR	How many pulses it gives per turn. Usually printed on the body.	Fitted 1 / 2	Whether each handwheel is connected.
Direction	Flips the counting direction without rewiring anything.	Drives 1 / 2	Which axis it winds.
Spindle / sensor pulley	Tooth counts, if the sensor is belt driven rather than straight off the spindle.	Invert 1 / 2	If it winds the wrong way.
Divider	Ignores very small movements, for a sensor that twitches at rest.	Pulses per rev	Of the handwheel itself.
Dead-band	How far the spindle must turn back before the tool follows it.	Min pulse width	Ignores electrical noise on its wiring.
Dead-band shape	One-way suits a worn lead screw; symmetric suits a noisy sensor.	Dead-band	Stops a wobble being read as a change of direction.
Glitch filter	Ignores electrical spikes. Set too high it starts missing real pulses.	Joystick	
		Fitted	Uses all six spare terminals, so nothing else can share them.
		Debounce	Ignores the brief chatter a switch makes as it closes.
		WiFi	
		Enabled	Makes the controller its own small network. Off means the radio is not on at all.
		Access PIN	The password, exactly 8 digits. Change it from the default.

Using it from a phone

1	Settings → WiFi → Enabled = yes. Change the Access PIN from the default first — anyone who can join the network can change the machine's settings.
2	Join the NanoEls-H4 network with that PIN, then open 192.168.4.1 . The panel shows the address.
3	Every setting is there, quicker to type than on the panel, with position and speed live. It also shows how clean the spindle sensor's signal is — leave it open through a job and check afterwards.
4	New firmware installs from the same page, with no computer at the machine. Only while it is stopped.

Choosing what it does

Each job has a key, shown in the table below. Two keys have a second job behind them: press the same key again to reach it, marked **×2**. What unit each job wants its numbers in is on page 1, along with the ratios the two taper jobs ask for.

M steps through the rest: **fourth axis** (if fitted) → **ball and dish** → **G-code** → **steady feed** → **slotting** → back to the gearbox

Job	Shows	Key	What it is for	Limits	What you can adjust
Gearbox	—		The carriage feeds along by itself as the spindle turns — what replaces change gears.	not needed	—
Cross-feed	XGEAR	 ×2	The same, driving the cross slide across the face. Powered facing.	not needed	—
Turning	TURN		Reduces a diameter over several passes, lifting the tool clear on each return.	all four	Passes · Spring passes · Clearance
Facing	FACE		Cleans up or shortens the end of the work, in several passes.	all four	Passes · Spring passes · Clearance
Parting	CUT		Cuts the work off, or cuts a groove. Can back out to clear the swarf.	up, down	Passes · Peck depth · Clearance
Threading	THRD		Cuts a screw thread, deeper each pass. Pick it from the list of 52 and the feed is set.	all four	Passes · Spring passes · Flank infeed · Clearance · Thread list
Tapered thread	TPR	 ×2	A thread on a taper rather than a parallel bar — pipe fittings, NPT and BSPT.	all four	as threading, plus its own taper
Taper	CONE		The tool moves in as it travels along, at a ratio you set. Feed in by hand.	not needed	taper ratio, asked at the start
Ball and dish	ELLI		Rounds the end into a ball, or hollows it into a dish.	all four	Passes
Slotting	SLOT		The lathe as a shaper: spindle still, tool stroking. Keyways and flats.	all four	Passes · Stroke shortening
Steady feed	ASY		A set feed rate with the spindle out of it. Handy for polishing.	not needed	—
G-code	GCODE		Runs a program written on a computer and sent over.	not needed	—
Fourth axis	A1		Drives a fourth motor, if you have fitted one.	not needed	—

Running one of the automatic jobs

1		Set the feed, then move the tool to each corner of the cut and press the matching limit key. On a thread the up limit is full thread depth — see below.
2		The bottom line reads ON to set up 3 steps . Press play to begin.
3		It asks a short series of questions. 1/3 tells you which one you are on and how many there are. <> means the arrow keys change the answer; otherwise type a number. Play accepts and moves on.
4		The last question is Go? , and it shows how far the tool will travel to reach the starting corner before it cuts anything. Play starts the job; stop takes you back to the beginning.
5		While it runs the line reads Pass 2 of 6 . Play skips to the next pass if you have taken enough off; stop, or any jog key, ends the job.

How deep should a thread go? The controller sets the pitch from its thread list, but it cannot know the depth — that is what the up limit tells it, and getting it wrong is the usual reason a first thread comes out badly. For an ordinary 60° thread the depth is **0.6134 × pitch** measured inwards from the surface, so an M10×1.5 goes 0.92mm deep. If the cross slide is set to read diameters rather than distance from centre, put in twice that.

Cutting a thread

1	Pick the thread from the machine's own list — press the settings key briefly while in threading, then choose it. That sets the feed.
2	Touch the tool on the outside of the bar and zero the cross slide. Set the down limit there: that is the surface.
3	Wind in by the depth from the thread table overleaf and set the up limit. That is full thread depth. In diameter readout, wind in twice the figure.
4	Set the two length limits, leaving room at the far end for the tool to come out — a run-out groove if the thread ends against a shoulder.
5	Six to ten passes suits most threads, plus a spring pass or two. More passes means a lighter cut each time and a better finish.

Every thread it knows

Choose one from the machine and the feed is set for you. **Depth** is how far in the tool has to go, in millimetres on the radius — that is what the up limit is for, and the one thing the controller cannot work out for itself. In diameter readout, put in twice the figure shown.

Thread	Pitch	Depth	Thread	Pitch	Depth	Thread	Pitch	Depth
Metric · 60°			Unified · UNC and UNF · 60°			British parallel pipe · 55°		
M3 coarse x0.5	0.50mm	0.31	1/4-20 UNC	20tpi	0.78	G1/8 BSPP 28tpi	28tpi	0.58
M4 coarse x0.7	0.70mm	0.43	1/4-28 UNF	28tpi	0.56	G1/4 BSPP 19tpi	19tpi	0.86
M5 coarse x0.8	0.80mm	0.49	5/16-18 UNC	18tpi	0.87	G3/8 BSPP 19tpi	19tpi	0.86
M6 coarse x1.0	1.00mm	0.61	5/16-24 UNF	24tpi	0.65	G1/2 BSPP 14tpi	14tpi	1.16
M8 coarse x1.25	1.25mm	0.77	3/8-16 UNC	16tpi	0.97	G3/4 BSPP 14tpi	14tpi	1.16
M8 fine x1.0	1.00mm	0.61	3/8-24 UNF	24tpi	0.65	G1 BSPP 11tpi	11tpi	1.48
M10 coarse x1.5	1.50mm	0.92	7/16-14 UNC	14tpi	1.11	Trapezoidal · 30°		
M10 fine x1.25	1.25mm	0.77	1/2-13 UNC	13tpi	1.20	Tr8x1.5 trap	1.50mm	1.00
M12 coarse x1.75	1.75mm	1.07	1/2-20 UNF	20tpi	0.78	Tr10x2 trap	2.00mm	1.25
M12 fine x1.5	1.50mm	0.92	5/8-11 UNC	11tpi	1.42	Tr12x3 trap	3.00mm	1.75
M14 coarse x2.0	2.00mm	1.23	5/8-18 UNF	18tpi	0.87	Tr16x4 trap	4.00mm	2.25
M16 coarse x2.0	2.00mm	1.23	3/4-10 UNC	10tpi	1.56	Tr20x4 trap	4.00mm	2.25
M16 fine x1.5	1.50mm	0.92	3/4-16 UNF	16tpi	0.97	ACME · 29°		
M20 coarse x2.5	2.50mm	1.53	1-8 UNC	8tpi	1.95	1/4-16 ACME	16tpi	1.05
M24 coarse x3.0	3.00mm	1.84				5/16-14 ACME	14tpi	1.16
						3/8-12 ACME	12tpi	1.31
						1/2-10 ACME	10tpi	1.52
						5/8-8 ACME	8tpi	1.84
						3/4-6 ACME	6tpi	2.37
						1-5 ACME	5tpi	2.79
						American taper pipe · 60° taper		
						1/8-27 NPT	27tpi	0.75
						1/4-18 NPT	18tpi	1.13
						3/8-18 NPT	18tpi	1.13
						1/2-14 NPT	14tpi	1.45
						3/4-14 NPT	14tpi	1.45

Depths are for a full-form thread on the outside of a bar. An internal thread is cut to the same depth outwards from the bore. Trapezoidal and ACME include the usual root clearance; taper pipe threads are deeper than they look because the form is truncated rather than pointed.

Cutting speeds

For setting the spindle yourself. Metres per minute at the **surface** of the work, not spindle rpm. These are starting points for turning, not limits — work up from them while the finish and the swarf still look happy, and halve them for parting off.

Material	HSS	Carbide	Material	HSS	Carbide
Aluminium	70 m/min	200 m/min	Alloy steel	20 m/min	90 m/min
Brass	60 m/min	180 m/min	Tool steel	15 m/min	60 m/min
Bronze	40 m/min	120 m/min	Stainless	15 m/min	60 m/min
Copper	50 m/min	150 m/min	Titanium	10 m/min	40 m/min
Cast iron	25 m/min	90 m/min	Plastic	100 m/min	250 m/min
Mild steel	30 m/min	120 m/min			

Spindle speed for that cutting speed

rpm = 318 × cutting speed ÷ diameter in mm, or read it off here: diameter down the side, metres per minute across the top. Round down to whatever your lathe offers — anything above its top speed just means run it flat out, which small diameters usually want.

Ø mm	20	30	60	90	120	200
10	640	950	1910	2860	3820	6370
16	400	600	1190	1790	2390	3980
20	320	480	950	1430	1910	3180
25	250	380	760	1150	1530	2550
32	200	300	600	900	1190	1990
40	160	240	480	720	950	1590
50	130	190	380	570	760	1270
63	100	150	300	450	610	1010
80	80	120	240	360	480	800
100	65	95	190	290	380	640